

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 843

By Cepicky

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Dr. Rufus R. Clifford, Jr.,
for his decades of distinguished service to the
community and to Rotary International.

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that the members of this General Assembly should honor those Tennesseans who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their years in public service; and

WHEREAS, one such estimable individual is Dr. Rufus R. Clifford, Jr., a respected physician, civic leader, and longtime Rotarian who celebrated his ninetieth birthday on January 19, 2026; and

WHEREAS, a practicing physician for fifty-five years, including two years of service in the United States Air Force, Dr. Clifford is especially known for his decades-long work as a pediatrician, providing compassionate and skillful care to thousands of children and families across Columbia, Maury County, and Southern Middle Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Rufus Clifford joined the Rotary Club of Columbia in 1987, inspired by Rotary International's global mission to eradicate polio, and he has remained an active and committed member ever since; and

WHEREAS, the Columbia Rotary Club was chartered in 1924, and the Columbia Breakfast Rotary Club was chartered in 1997; both combined to become the largest nonprofit service organization in Maury County, creating a rich and unique tradition of community service in this area; and

WHEREAS, a strong believer in Rotary's creed of "Service Above Self," Dr. Clifford has played an instrumental role in numerous local service projects and charitable initiatives, leaving a lasting impact on individuals, families, and community organizations; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Rufus Clifford served with distinction as president of the Columbia Rotary Club in 1997–1998 and as District Governor of Rotary International District 6760 in 2007–2008, providing leadership to all Rotary clubs across Middle and West Tennessee under the theme "Rotary Shares"; and

WHEREAS, throughout his many years of professional and civic service, Dr. Clifford has exemplified the highest standards of integrity, leadership, and commitment to others, winning the unbridled respect and admiration of his colleagues and citizens alike; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Dr. Rufus R. Clifford, Jr., for his many years of exemplary service in medicine and in Rotary International, extending to him our best wishes on the celebration of his ninetieth birthday and continued happiness in the years to come.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.